A SHIPPER'S RESOURCE

Philippine Market Entry Readiness Checklist

12 things to confirm before you book your next shipment, so nothing slips at the border.

Why Starting Without a Plan Costs You

First-time importers commonly buy and ship before the business structure, registrations and permits are settled. Mills Entry sequences those steps with Mills Permits and Mills Customs, so your first shipment arrives into a business that is ready to receive it.

Work through each point before you book. If you cannot tick a box, that is the item to resolve first.

The Readiness Checklist

- [ ] **1. Your business model and products are defined**
  Write down what you will import, sell or manufacture, who the customers are, and where you plan to operate.

- [ ] **2. The entry structure has been reviewed**
  Compare options such as a local company, a branch or a distributor arrangement, with legal and tax advice where needed.

- [ ] **3. Company incorporation is coordinated**
  Confirm who is handling incorporation, what documents are needed from you, and the order of the steps involved.

- [ ] **4. Business registrations and local permits are lined up**
  Check the registrations and local permits needed to operate in your city or zone, and who will file each one.

- [ ] **5. Importer and exporter readiness is confirmed**
  Confirm that the accreditation needed to import or export in your company's name is in place before any goods ship.

- [ ] **6. Product and industry permits are mapped**
  Identify any permit, license or product registration your goods need, and which agency issues it.

- [ ] **7. Incentive options are assessed**
  If your activity may qualify for PEZA or BOI incentives, confirm eligibility and process before you commit to a location.

- [ ] **8. Tax, banking and bookkeeping are ready**
  Set up what you need to pay for the first import and record it properly, with your accountant's guidance.

- [ ] **9. Landed cost is estimated**
  Estimate freight, duties, taxes and handling before you set prices, so margins hold after the goods arrive.

The Readiness Checklist (continued)

- [ ] **10. The first shipment is planned end to end**
  Line up your forwarder, broker, trucking and storage for the first shipment, and agree who coordinates them.

- [ ] **11. Customs and agency contacts are assigned**
  Decide who handles customs and agency questions, so nothing waits on the one person who is unavailable.

- [ ] **12. A post-registration compliance calendar exists**
  List renewals, periodic filings and reviews with owners, so registrations and permits stay active after launch.

Not sure every box is ticked? Let Mills Entry review it with you.

Book a short call and we will walk through your next shipment and flag anything to resolve before it moves.

BOOK A CALL

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General guidance only, not legal advice. Requirements vary by product and shipment; confirm with The Mills before booking.